

Research Methods for IT Professionals

Research Proposal Assignment (Assessment Two)

Basic Guidelines for Kick-starting your Assignment

20 April 2020, Lynn Coleman

Step ONE

What is the assignment asking you to do?

Assessment Two (2): The Research Proposal

Research Methods for IT Professionals

REM474S, REM475S, REM477S

DUE DATE: Wednesday 3 June 2020 @ 4pm (30%)

Produce a full research proposal that describes and outlines the empirical research project you are planning to undertake as part of the assessment requirements for this subject. For your Advanced Diploma studies you are required to plan, design and implement a small scale empirical research project based within the IT Professional context. **You are required to work in pairs.**

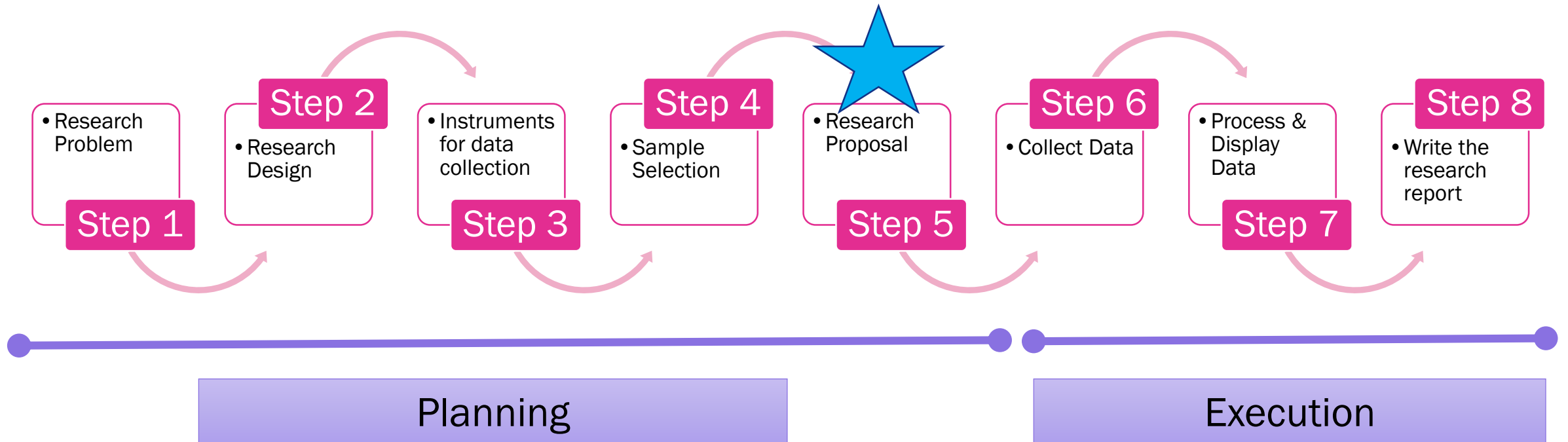
1. Produce a **research proposal**
2. Based on **EMPIRICAL** research
3. Linked to general **assessment focus** of the subject
 - Plan, design and implement a **small scale empirical research project based within the IT Professional context**
4. Work in **pairs** (that two people)

Step ONE

What is the assignment asking you to do?

Unpacking the assignment requirements

What is a research proposal?



Plan, design and implement a small scale empirical research project based within the IT Professional context



• Empirical

- Concrete evidence mostly from observations
- Gathering evidence, collecting data about the topic/phenomena first hand
 - experiments, interviews, questionnaires, direct observations
- **LEARNING OUTCOME**
 - Propose, design and conduct a small-scale research investigation, located in the IT professional context using basic questionnaire design

• IT Professional Context



- FOCUS on IT as discipline/field of practice
 - Software development, data-base management, call centre, IT support, ISP, business analysis, IT technician, mobile application developer, programmer, web developer/web designer, website manager
- CONCERNS, GAPS, QUESTIONS in your work context
- **People** (end-users, designers/developers), **Phenomena** (models, methods, approaches), **Programmes** (tools), **Problems** (users, technology, context)
- **Applied research**



- Not pure or basic research
- Not building an artefact
- Not pointing to another field (education, politics, cultural studies)
 - Online learning for primary school children in SA during Covid-19
 - Mobile App usage during Covid-19

Step ONE

What is the assignment asking you to do?

Unpacking the assignment requirements

Technical Requirements

Technical requirements

- Structure of proposal (*following the brief*)
- Work in pairs



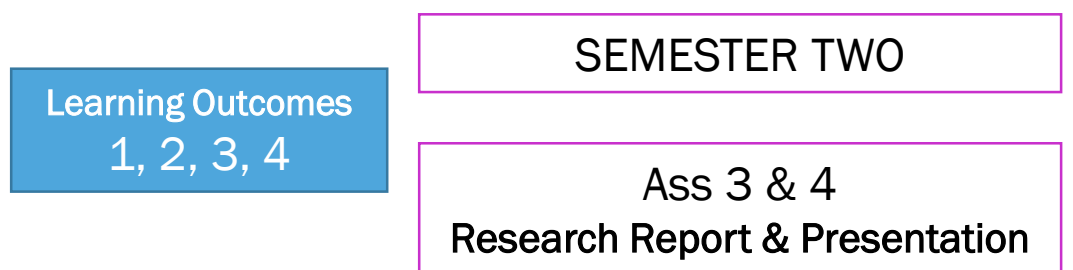
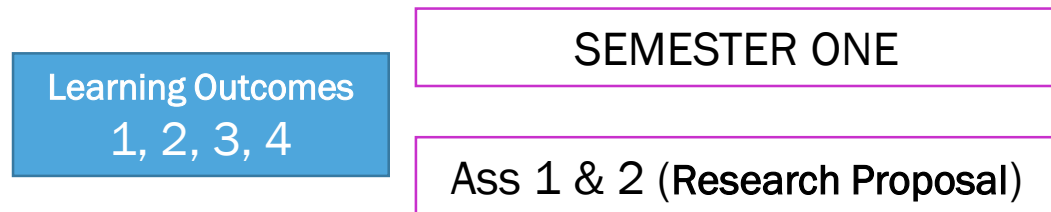
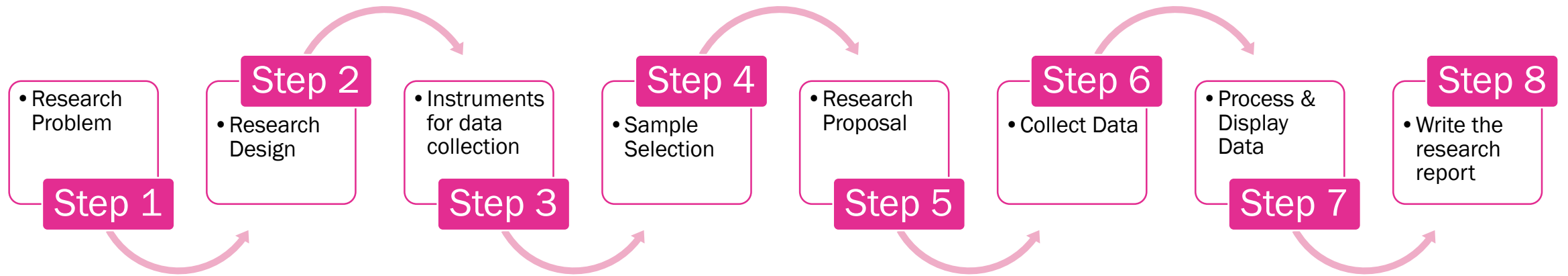
*Request permission,
motivate why*



Step TWO

The bigger picture

linking Assessment 2 to Assessment 3 & 4



let's chat

THOUGHTS?
QUESTIONS?

BLACKBOARD DISCUSSION FORUM?

SKYPE?